SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

EXPLORING THE TOURIST EXPERIENCE AND ITS EFFECT TO TOURIST SATISFACTION AND LOYALTY

A Thesis Proposal Presented To
The Faculty of College of Tourism and Hospitality Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
Saint Michael College of Caraga

By

REVILOVE R. BATOKAN
LIESEL P. BISNAR
NEKKA ESPINOSA
NOREEN GEN LAURENTE
JHAIZA G. PASTO
RHEA GRAE C. YBANEZ

ADVISER: **MS. MARICEL CONCEPTION L. PABATANG**

NOVEMBER 2025

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of Study

Tourism is recognised as one of the most dynamic sectors of the global economy, contributing to social interaction, cultural exchange, employment generation, and overall well-being. It has evolved from simple leisure travel into an experience-centered activity that promotes personal development and emotional enrichment. Modern tourists now seek meaningful and transformative journeys that enhance their physical, mental, and even spiritual state, making tourism a complex co-creation process between hosts and guests rather than a passive form of consumption (Khan, 2020).

Globally, wellness tourism has shown rapid growth, reaching $821.75 billion in 2022 and expected to rise to $2.1 trillion in 2023, with continued expansion through 2030. Countries like Indonesia, especially Bali, demonstrate the increasing value of wellness-focused destinations by leveraging natural resources and cultural practices to support healing and rejuvenation (Wang & Azzizurrohman, 2025). As studies have shown, wellness destinations thrive when they strengthen destination attractiveness and respond to tourists' internal motivations such as improving quality of life (Subawa et al., 2023).

Wellness tourism involves travelers who intentionally seek activities that promote physical, mental, and social well-being. These experiences include spa treatments, yoga sessions, fitness programs, nutrition workshops, and relaxation therapies (Dillette et al., 2020). In the Philippines, Wellness and Spa Centers—such as those found in Batangas—demonstrate how

wellness facilities can enhance social wellness and relaxation for tourists through various healing practices, fitness classes, and lifestyle activities (Cabuntagon et al., 2025). This rising interest reflects a global trend toward health consciousness, stress reduction, and the pursuit of work-life balance (Putrevu & Mertzanis, 2025).

The rationale of this study is to examine how tourists' well-being influences their satisfaction and loyalty, particularly within the context of Butuan City. As tourism becomes more experience-driven, understanding what enhances visitors' wellness can help strengthen their overall travel experience and encourage repeat visits. The findings of this study will benefit several stakeholders, including tourists who will enjoy improved services and wellness experiences; local government units and tourism agencies who can develop better programs; business owners and tourism operators who can enhance their facilities; and the CTHM Department, which can use the study as an academic reference to improve curriculum relevance and support student learning in tourism and hospitality fields.

Lastly, this study will also be beneficial to travel operators, hospitality managers, and future researchers by providing insights into the factors that influence tourists' emotional well-being, satisfaction, and loyalty. It will serve as a foundation for understanding tourist behavior in relation to wellness-oriented experiences and can contribute to the development of improved tourism policies, management practices, and future academic investigations in the area of wellness and destination loyalty.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

This study is grounded in two complementary theoretical perspectives that explain how tourist experiences shape satisfaction and loyalty. The first foundation is Seligman's Authentic Happiness Theory (2011), which conceptualizes well-being through three pathways: pleasure, engagement, and meaning. In the context of tourism, these pathways provide a psychological basis for understanding how tourists derive happiness from their experiences. The Pleasant Life reflects the hedonic aspect of travel, where tourists seek enjoyable emotions such as relaxation, comfort, excitement, and positive moods during their visit. The Engaged Life emerges when tourists participate deeply in activities that capture their attention, allowing them to experience "flow" a state where they become fully absorbed in cultural performances, nature immersion, adventures, or wellness activities. Meanwhile, the Meaningful Life becomes relevant when travel experiences allow tourists to feel connected to a place, culture, community, or purpose beyond themselves, fostering a sense of fulfillment and personal growth. These dimensions are essential in explaining how tourist well-being develops and how it influences their post-visit attitudes.

Supporting this psychological foundation is the 4Es experiential framework of Bagheri et al. (2023)—escapism, esthetic, education, and entertainment which clarifies how the structure and quality of the tourist experience influence satisfaction and loyalty within tourism settings. Escapism highlights tourists' desire to temporarily detach from routine, contributing to emotional renewal and enjoyment. Esthetic elements such as scenery, ambiance, and destination design enhance the visual and sensory quality of the experience. Education relates to learning opportunities that enrich a visitor's knowledge, cultural understanding, or personal skills. Entertainment and overall environment shape the enjoyment, novelty, and memorability of the

trip. These experiential dimensions are closely linked to tourist satisfaction, as they determine whether visitors perceive the experience as meaningful, enjoyable, and worth repeating. Prior studies show that high-quality experiences do more than generate immediate satisfaction they also build emotional attachment, influence revisit intentions, and strengthen loyalty behaviors such as recommendations and positive word-of-mouth.

Integrating these two frameworks offers a comprehensive explanation of how tourist experiences lead to satisfaction and loyalty. Authentic Happiness Theory explains the internal psychological processes through which tourists derive happiness from pleasurable, engaging, and meaningful encounters. Meanwhile, the 4Es model provides the external experiential components that shape how tourists evaluate their visit. By integrating these perspectives, this study aims to examine how different elements of the tourist experience contribute to well-being, and how this enhanced well-being ultimately increases tourist satisfaction and loyalty. This synthesized framework not only aligns with current tourism literature but also supports the study's goal of identifying specific experiential factors that drive positive post-visit behaviors among tourists.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

Travelling is no longer just for the rich. It is needed for a good life. Travel helps a person's physical, emotional, and social well-being. Tourism is a key factor in well-being. It is now seen as vital to a high quality of life, boosting our health and social connections (Bagheri et al., 2024). In fact, that good feeling about a vacation is the strongest link between the trip and a person's overall well-being (Yudhistira et al., 2024). Both travel motivation and emotional experience directly affect eudaimonic well-being, and eudaimonic well-being directly affects both tourist satisfaction and destination loyalty. Additionally, travel motivation and emotional experience have significant indirect impacts on post-consumption behaviours mediated by eudaimonic well-being (Al-okaily et al., 2022).

According to data from the Global Wellness Institute, the global wellness industry is expected to grow at an average annual rate of 21% from USD 435.7 billion in 2020 to USD 1127.6 billion in 2025. Wellness tourism is a type of tourism with a high added value. Compared with ordinary tourists, wellness tourists spend more than 60% more on average, experience higher tourism satisfaction, and tend to repeat the same types of tourism activities. To this end, tourism destinations and tourism-related enterprises have implemented active tourism marketing promotions and improved the reputation and image of tourism destinations through social media, advertising, mobile marketing, and other ways, which not only provides a reference for potential wellness tourism consumers but also plays a role in boosting the well-being and satisfaction of tourists with relevant tourism experiences (Liu et al., 2023). Some key findings include that the greater the trip's impact on tourists' sense of well-being, the greater the loyalty towards the destination. Different cultures yielded different results regarding trip experiences (satisfaction) and their effects on subjective well-being. Physical exercises, which are essential for overall health, including physical, psychological, emotional, and mental well-being (Florea et al., 2023), improve self-esteem (Tikac et al., 2022) and show positive correlations with motivations for competition and

enjoyment in the case of men, while physical appearance and social relationships are more relevant for women (Inoue et al., 2024).

Age

Young tourists aging 15-30 years old are considered the fast-growing and highly important group of tourists in today's tourism business. These young travellers are particularly attractive to destinations because they are identified to stay longer and spend more than the average international tourist (Han et al., 2021). They possess a high lifetime value, as they frequently revisit destinations later in life, making them a sustained source of revenue. Indicates that their intention to visit a destination is positively influenced by factors such as their perceived expertise, health consciousness, and the perceived benefits of the trip. Conversely, their intention to visit is negatively affected by the level of perceived risk associated with the destination (Annanukul & Yoopetch, 2022) . On the other hand young tourists activity is a combination of recreation, health improvement, increasing of physical activity, fulfillment the need of being active, forming a mindful attitude towards own health, and mindfulness of responsibility to stay healthy (Solomchack, 2020).

Understanding the value perceptions of young tourists and how these evaluations influence their satisfaction and future behavioral intentions towards a destination is crucial, as this segment is recognized as one of the most dynamic, rapidly growing, and effective in the tourism market. While young tourists, like other segments, seek high value from their travel experiences, their perception of this value is heavily influenced by epistemic (knowledge-related) and emotional factors, leading them to place greater importance on the psychological aspects of a trip. Additionally, the creation of value for this segment is also dependent on the destination's infra- and upper-structural factors, which are reflected in the functional value they perceive (Caber et al., 2020).

Three most important product advantages for the elderly when choosing leisure service facilities are: 1. the quality of service; 2. emergency guidance measures; and 3. health management awareness.

Wellness tourism emphasizes the provision of a full range of services for the elderly to provide physical and mental balance. The elderly may start to care more about their health at 65 years or younger because they think that wellness tourism can bring something different or beneficial to their life and health. Wellness tourism must be conditional on leisure and pleasure, and it should improve a sense of happiness. The elderly, when obtaining wellness travel, often seek to obtain physical and mental health, prevent, or delay physical diseases and functional decline, and wellness tourism should be enjoyable with positive recreational, physical, and mental side-effects (Kan et al., 2023).

Age is a significant moderating factor that influences tourists' behavioral intentions and satisfaction, particularly in the relationship between destination features like attraction and accessibility. Specifically, visitors younger than 39 years tend to prioritize participatory experiences and demonstrate a stronger self-awareness during their travels (Tavitiyaman et al., 2021). In contrast, older tourists place a greater emphasis on producing value from their experiences, exhibit higher brand loyalty, and generally seek good, reliable experiences. Furthermore, older consumers tend to show more resistance to adopting new technological experiences incorporated into tourism products compared to their younger counterparts (Karim et al., 2024).

Educational Attainment

Educational attainment profoundly impacts the travel decision-making process. Highly educated tourists tend to be active information seekers, relying more on digital sources, complex reviews, and specialized travel articles rather than basic advertisements. They also exhibit higher levels of critical evaluation regarding service quality, sustainability practices, and the overall value proposition of a destination (Gómez & Mollá, 2020).

The influence of a tourist's educational background extends directly to their expectations and overall satisfaction with the destination. The level of education can create significant differences in how tourists evaluate the various attributes of a service or attraction. For instance, tourists with higher

educational attainment may be more critical of environmental practices, historical interpretation, and the professionalism of staff, leading to potentially different satisfaction outcomes compared to those with lower educational levels. Therefore, understanding the educational profile of the market in Butuan City is vital for tailoring tourism development efforts, ensuring that services, facilities, and promotional materials are sophisticated enough to meet the expectations of this highly evaluative segment, thereby fostering their well-being and loyalty.

Frequency of Visit

Tourists who visit a destination repeatedly are the most valuable market segment. These repeat visitors are often assumed to possess higher levels of satisfaction, trust, and attachment to the destination compared to first-time visitors, which translates into beneficial economic outcomes. For destination management organizations (DMOs) and hospitality businesses, a rising frequency of visit is a key performance indicator, as loyal customers require lower marketing expenditures and often contribute positive word-of-mouth referrals, driving sustainable growth (Rather, 2021).

However, the relationship between visit frequency and satisfaction is complex and requires careful segmentation, as high frequency does not always equate to true, deep-seated loyalty. The perceived satisfaction levels for repeat guests can sometimes be lower than for first-time guests, possibly due to a decline in novelty or inertia-based revisiting (Shankar et al., 2021).

Sex

Female tourists generally report higher satisfaction and subjective well-being compared to male tourists. This trend is partly attributed to female consumers being more social and their purchasing behavior often being driven by the pursuit of pleasure and well-being (Su et al., 2022). A key difference lies in their approach to travel safety: female tourists tend to pay more attention to safety concerns during a trip. If they feel anxious due to safety issues, they are also more willing to seek help than male tourists, which can contribute to forming their subjective well-being (Wang et al., 2023). Furthermore, the genders

differ in how they pursue well-being through experience: females gain higher well-being and life satisfaction from meaningful experiences, while males tend to obtain higher life satisfaction and well-being through pleasant experiences (Wadsworth & Pendergast, 2021).

Tourist Experiences

Customer experience in hospitality and tourism perspectives has been discovered in the context of golf tournaments, temple stays, hotel experience, visitors' experience, wine trails, bed and breakfast settings, etc. This consists of mental balance, physical balance, and environmental and social balance. Destination suppliers put all their efforts into satisfying the tourists experiences and providing them with all the necessary products and services to enhance their well-being, intellectual development, growth of mind and body, and spirit enhancement. Spas, including the health-oriented services and water treatments, springs, hot water, etc., are well believe to give a positive benefits with the tourists.

The tourist have identified experience in four dimensions: entertainment, education, aesthetics, and escapism. The same has been applied in the tourism and hospitality literature. The four realms of experiences are considered essential for enhancing total quality services excellence, customer satisfaction, and repeat business. With the increase in global travel, tourists now focus on such tourism services or products which may create enjoyment, lifetime memory, a reasonable involvement of tourists, and hence "experience economy", which has now become a growing consideration for hospitality and tourism. The spa sector has achieved speedy growth after experiencing rapid customer interest in tourism products and services, contributing to their well-being and raising several promotion opportunities. spas could present to enhance the customer's minds and bodies it is also necessary to analyze the possible benefits of spa therapy experience on the well-being of customers as it booms the principles of modern marketing by emphasizing the worth of life in hospitality and tourism business.

1.1.5.1. Emotional Intensity & Enjoyment (Entertainment)

The experience of entertainment during travel is a significant factor in shaping a tourist's perception of well-being and the enhancement of their quality of life, largely by creating unforgettable, pleasant memories. Tourist experiences within the entertainment dimension are characterized by passive participation and absorption (Tercia et al., 2020). In this scenario, tourists function as observers or audiences, meaning there is no direct interaction with the destination; their focus is solely on receiving information and entertainment, resulting in a one-way experience. The benefits derived from this passive engagement include relaxation, education, cultural experiences, enjoyment, satisfaction, and memory-building (Wong et al., 2022).

Tourist experiences within the entertainment dimension involve passive participation and emotional absorption. Tourists often act as observers or audiences, engaging with destinations through performances, storytelling, or curated activities that foster relaxation and enjoyment (Lamopia, 2023). The empathy displayed by destination staff is crucial for significantly boosting the emotional engagement of tourists (Biswas et al., 2021). Practices such as personalized care and careful attention to individual needs work together to create a welcoming and memorable environment. These positive experiences directly promote feelings of relaxation and happiness, which in turn build deep emotional connections with the destination, ultimately enhancing both tourist satisfaction and loyalty (Sthapit et al., 2022). Furthermore, destinations can integrate sustainability by incorporating practices into their entertainment-focused activities, such as utilizing renewable energy for performances or offering cultural showcases that are specifically designed to preserve and promote local traditions.

1.1.5.2. Personal Enrichment (Education)

People expand their knowledge by direct personal experiential learning in tourist destinations. Education reflects active participation because people need a high level of voluntary participation in the performances/events in order to acquire skills and knowledge (Stylidis, 2020). In addition, education is viewed as absorption because it refers to “occupying a person’s attention by bringing the experience into

the mind". The educational experience aids to increase perceived value, which leads to a high level of traveler satisfaction. the educational experience plays a crucial role in forming well-being perceptions because people feel that such an experience improves their quality of life (Paulose & Shakeel, 2022).

Tourists directly engage in learning processes, interact with destinations, and develop new skills and knowledge. These experiences emphasize practical engagement and self-transformation (Tomasi et al., 2020). Benefits include gaining new knowledge and skills, practical experiences, local interactions, satisfaction, self-development, memory-building, and access to local knowledge. Educational experiences involve active participation and intellectual engagement, where tourists directly interact with the destination to acquire knowledge and skills (Julianto & Ardianti, 2022). Activities such as workshops on local health practices, meditation techniques, and sustainability initiatives enable tourists to deepen their understanding of wellness and environmental conservation. These experiences often lead to self-transformation as tourists gain insights into their well-being while learning about the destination's culture and heritage. For example, guided tours emphasizing the sustainable use of local resources can raise awareness about responsible consumption and production, aligning with SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production) (Majeed & Gon, 2023)

1.1.5.3. Physical and Mental Activity/Restoration (Escapism)

The desire to escape the difficulties of everyday life is a primary driver for people seeking a change, and travel is a crucial way to achieve this, offering both mental and physical relaxation. One of the important ways to escape from the monotony of daily life is to travel where people can relax both mentally and physically. This pursuit of a new environment and activities is essentially escapism, helping individuals break free from their dull routines to lead a more leisurely life and recharge their mind and body. Certain travel activities lead to high levels of escapism. For instance, being completely mesmerized by performances or events is classified as immersion. Likewise, engaging in water sports such as surfing, water skiing, and flyboarding allows people to feel a high degree of escapism.

These activities enable tourists to disconnect from their daily routines and immerse themselves in transformative experiences that promote emotional well-being. Escapist activities can also be designed to minimize environmental impact, such as offering guided eco-hikes or promoting zero-waste policies at cultural events. By integrating these sustainable practices, destinations can enhance the quality of escapist experiences while supporting biodiversity and reducing carbon footprints.

Fitness Gym

The importance of physical fitness, which encompasses components like endurance, power, muscle strength, balance, speed, reaction time, and body composition, is widely recognized for nurturing the body through exercise. Despite this awareness, the demands of modern social and work life often lead to compromising physical exercise. Consequently, fitness gyms and the use of fitness coaches have become increasingly popular as people seek to maintain a healthy body. However, while controlling one's diet is also crucial, the profession of a dietician or nutritionist is not as popular or widely sought out. These specialists are typically found only in hospitals, wellness centers, and occasionally schools, and there is a general lack of interest among the public in consulting them.

Spa and Relaxation

A balanced well-being can be achieved through a variety of services and practices, central to which is the pursuit of wellness. These services include alternative medicine and treatments, mental learning activities, treatments that specifically promote relaxation, maintaining a healthy, sustainable diet, and engaging in social activities. Spiritual wellness is a highly significant motivator for wellness travelers, ranking as the second most common reason for visiting a spa (Kessler et al., 2020). Spas often offer practices like Harmonizing Flow, a type of meditation designed to facilitate self-knowledge and balance the harmony of the mind, body, and spirit.Given the pervasive nature of stress and negative influences in the modern world, it is vital to cure negative feelings and thoughts to ensure that energy flows positively

(Saari et al., 2023). Although often perceived as boring, these mind activities are remarkably effective for the mind, emotions, and body. They serve to collect energy and offer it to the inner self, maintaining internal balance and enabling the release of negative thoughts and feelings. Ultimately, wellness services are comprehensive activities that involve nurturing all the dimensions of wellness.

Furthermore, it has been found that spa therapies provide pressure relief, a pampering experience, and easing of the whole body, resulting in body, soul, and mind improvement, hence enhancing a person's overall health. With regard to the growing health consciousness of customers and analysis of adult traveler's evaluation of service on wellness tourism, it has been seen that spa resorts have thus assimilated various therapy treatments, such as yoga in India, salt therapy in Germany, mud therapy in Israel, and massage in Thailand, etc. (Singh et al., 2022).

1.1.5.4. Sensory & Environmental Immersion (Aesthetic)

Aesthetic qualities of a tourist destination may affect tourists' experience and satisfaction, contributing to their loyalty toward a destination and intention to return. Although tourists can sense beauty, ugliness, or other aesthetic qualities in nature without knowing much about the process, culture plays a key role in an aesthetic experience. Additionally, for nature-based tourism destinations, tourist loyalty is an important issue, and tourism-related aesthetic experiences may significantly contribute to loyalty (Zhang & Xu, 2020).

Engaging tourists through sensory experiences is vital for building lasting connections. These experiences have been found to positively affect tourists' memories by targeting their emotions. In turn, this positive influence on memories leads to increased tourist loyalty. Therefore, avenues for engaging tourists should strategically focus on leveraging the powerful link between sensory experiences, emotions, and destination memories (Yang et al., 2021). However, wellness tourism destinations often capitalize on natural beauty and eco-friendly architectural designs to create a tranquil and rejuvenating atmosphere. Examples include spas located in lush natural settings or retreats featuring sustainable

design elements such as green roofs and renewable energy systems. Caring for the environment makes guests feel good emotionally, which builds positive memories and makes them more likely to keep coming back (Marhaeni,2023).

Tourist Satisfaction

Tourist satisfaction is tourists' emotional state when they enjoy the tourism experience or an overall evaluation of the whole tourism process, such as satisfaction with tourism products and services (Suban, 2025). Tourism activities' positive impacts have been proven: when tourists feel a unique and positive tourism experience consistent with their expected goals, a higher level of satisfaction is achieved (Torabi et al., 2022). The absence of such an experience will reduce tourists' satisfaction and well-being. That is, in the process of wellness tourism, tourists' leisure and entertainment, service quality, destination environment, differences from place of residence, degree of tourist participation, and other factors have been analyzed. When the experience is consistent with or better than expected, it reflects a higher degree of satisfaction (Huang et al., 2024).

Tourist satisfaction is a part of tourist well-being, which is an extension of the field. Tourists acquire new skills or knowledge in the process of the wellness tourism experience; those who identify with the destination or form good memories usually have higher satisfaction and well-being. Tourist satisfaction regard it as an intermediary variable to study the mediating role of tourist satisfaction in the relationship between the cause and outcome variables. Tourist satisfaction and the antecedent variables of tourist well-being, finding that tourist satisfaction positively impacts tourists' well-being. Hence, a good tourism experience can lead to cognitive, emotional, and sensory stimulation, thereby improving tourists' satisfaction and happiness. When tourists are satisfied with their travel experience, it enhances their sense of value in life, their capacity to resist negative information, and increases their overall life happiness (Bagheri et al., 2024).

1.1.6.2. Service Quality

Service Quality is the backbone of tourist satisfaction in the hospitality industry, and its role is amplified in the specialized context of wellness tourism. Perceived quality of service in accommodation from the moment of check-in to final departure has a direct and positive effect on a tourist's satisfaction (Ashton & Islam, 20225). For a wellness traveler, service quality is defined by the reliable and consistent delivery of services that support their health goals. Key dimensions, often adapted from models like SERVQUAL, include Reliability (performing promised services accurately, like punctuality for spa treatments), Responsiveness (willingness to help customers promptly, especially in wellness-related requests), and Assurance (the competence and trustworthiness of staff, such as therapists or fitness trainers). When these service dimensions are perceived as high, the tourist's positive evaluation of the service leads directly to a strong sense of satisfaction with the accommodation (Abdou et al., 2022).

Furthermore, service quality is crucial because it significantly enhances the mediating function of satisfaction in boosting well-being. Wellness tourists have high expectations not only for the tangible facilities (like spa equipment and room aesthetics) but especially for the empathy and personalized attention provided by the staff, which are intangible service elements. Staff who demonstrate a caring, knowledgeable, and customized approach to the guest's unique health needs such as dietary restrictions, stress management, or physical activity requirements make the overall experience feel more valuable and therapeutic. By ensuring that the service quality consistently exceeds these expectations, the accommodation maximizes the tourist's satisfaction, which then acts as a more effective conduit to achieving the positive emotional and psychological outcomes that constitute improved well-being.

1.1.7. Tourist Loyalty

Tourist loyalty can include constructs such as revisit intention, positive word-of-mouth intention, and willingness to pay a premium. More importantly, the motivation to visit rural areas for urban residents

may be different than for rural residents. tourists' perceived quality was seen as an essential prerequisite leading to tourist loyalty.

1.1.7.1. Intention to Revisit

Loyalty, generally measured by the desire to return to a destination or service provider (revisit intention) and the willingness to recommend it to others (word-of-mouth), is strongly and positively influenced by a tourist's high satisfaction (Seo wt al., 2024). Well-being acts as an initial driver: when the travel experience successfully boosts a tourist's sense of health, happiness, and life quality (their well-being), it significantly elevates their feeling of satisfaction. This elevated satisfaction, driven by profound well-being benefits, then leads to robust loyalty, manifesting specifically as a firm intention to revisit the destination for repeated wellness engagement (Singh et al., 2022).

For the wellness tourism sector, this loyalty-revisit relationship is especially pronounced because wellness is often viewed as a dynamic, continuous process rather than a one-time event. Tourists seeking sustained physical, mental, or spiritual improvement are highly motivated to return to a trusted location that has proven effective in delivering these benefits (Buzinde, 2020). Therefore, a tourist's high loyalty, which stems from a deeply satisfying and well-being-enhancing experience, serves as the immediate predictor of their future intention to revisit. Destination managers in this sector place a high value on cultivating loyalty because repeat visitors represent a stable revenue stream and require lower marketing costs than first-time visitors, underscoring the vital link between a tourist's positive well-being outcome, their resulting loyalty, and the commercial viability of the destination through revisit intentions.

1.1.7.2. Willingness to Recommend to Others

A tourist's intent to recommend a destination or service to their social circle reflects a level of loyalty that goes beyond mere personal return. This occurs when the experience is so positively impactful—first by contributing significantly to their well-being (making them feel healthier, more relaxed, or happier), and second, by generating exceptional satisfactionthat the tourist feels compelled to share their positive outcome and advocate for the service provider. This transition from personal satisfaction to public endorsement is vital for the growth of the wellness tourism sector (Akbari et al., 2021).

Furthermore, the credibility associated with positive WOM is immense, as recommendations from friends and family are often trusted more than traditional advertising. For a wellness experience, this recommendation reflects not just a good vacation, but a successful investment in one's personal health, lending significant weight to the advice. Thus, a tourist's high satisfaction and improved well-being solidify their loyalty, which is outwardly expressed through this strong willingness to recommend. This advocacy not only serves as a reliable metric for service quality but also directly drives new business, making it a crucial component in exploring the full effect of well-being on overall tourist loyalty and the long-term success of wellness tourism offerings (Wu et al., 2024).

International Literature

Wellness tourism is now growing and is seen as a key part of travel. It is developing in places like Bali and Bandung. Wellness travel is a mindful type of vacation. Since its goal is to boost your health, it requires a clean, respected environment. This is precisely what sustainable tourism aims to create and maintain (Albasrie, 2024). Island tourism is pivotal in regional economies, offering livelihoods through hospitality services, heritage preservation, and small-scale entrepreneurship (Kesuma et al., 2025). Yet its sustainable success hinges on visitor flows and meaningful stakeholder involvement, particularly residents' collaboration, commitment, and positive engagement in tourism planning and management (Javdan et al.,2024)

Health and Well-being (H&W) tourism attractions rely on three key parts to positively affect a person's well-being: they must have a unique and memorable identity, their activities must leave a lasting impression and offer a real learning experience, and they should include local people who make and sell wellness products to travellers. For a healthy and welcoming destination to succeed, it must address several factors, including effective management, strong design and service innovation, clear policy and planning, and the organisation's ability to learn and manage knowledge (Koh et al., 2022).

These countries are protecting their culture and using new ideas to boost wellness tourism, especially for older travellers. Culture and innovation make a travel spot better and help the local economy grow. Special trips for older adults are needed to help them recover from stress. The environment and the wellness benefits they get are both critical. Mixing creative economy ideas with wellness improves the quality of trips, making them feel real and unique. This helps these destinations stand out. As the global population ages, combining wellness tourism with the creative economy can help tourism grow over time while meeting the needs of older travellers. Governments should focus on preserving culture and innovating to offer good, useful amenities for tourists. This not only makes visitors happy but also builds loyalty (Keadplang et al., 2025).

Wellness tourism generates chances for wellness enterprises. The expenditures of wellness travellers benefit all areas of the tourism industry. Based on its importance to the Thai economy, combined with the increasing interest in wellness tourist destinations (Arphawatthansakul & Punyasiri, 2024). Meditation retreat tourism is unique. The challenges in its technique and process, and the benefits gained, are reported to be worth the effort in reconciling mind, body, and spirit. Regarding the effects on health and well-being, international tourists reported that their minds had developed the most (mental well-being), followed by spiritual and physiological well-being (Piuchan, 2021).

Local Literature

The Philippines is an agrarian-based tourism country; millions of tourists come to visit every year. However, most first-time visitors leave the question of why so few people decide to return for a tour of the Philippines' tourist destinations unanswered (Libre et al., 2022). A tourism destination should offer amenities that meet visitors' needs, ensuring their comfort and satisfaction during their visit. This can make a tourist destination successful and give tourists a positive experience. Amenities are items that service providers intentionally provide for customers to use and enjoy, thereby maximising customer pleasure (Liao et al., 2020). When tourist facilities deliver maximum pleasure to guests, they establish a solid foundation for future trips and readiness to share pleasant experiences with others, fostering loyalty.

Tourist satisfaction and loyalty in the Philippines come from travellers' experiences. As both foreign and local visitors tour the country, they look beyond the places. They judge their trip based on how fulfilled they feel emotionally, psychologically, and physically. When tourists feel safe, relaxed, and culturally enriched during their stay, their well-being goes up. This leads to greater satisfaction and stronger loyalty to the destination (Bagheri et al., 2023). Destinations that promote wellness tourism and offer opportunities for recreation, comfort, and self-discovery encourage repeat visits and positive word-of-mouth recommendations. Enhancing tourist well-being not only improves satisfaction but also fosters long-term loyalty to Philippine destinations (Chua et al., 2025).

However, according to Alcontin et. al. (2025), in Batangas Province, it is known that Spa provides this services ranging from massages to Filipino traditional treatments like Hilot Massage. Spa is a place that has the qualities of being calm, quiet and peaceful. It is very common to have yoga and meditation, spa treatments and massages as the most popular treatment. Coaching and counselling, nutrition, emotional and spiritual guidance and healing, nature and outdoor activities and stress relief activities such as laughter therapy are the services present in most of the wellness spa. On the other hand, Nowadays, fitness gym and fitness coach are getting popular because of the awareness of the people on the importance of healthy body. (Mercado & Apritado, 2021).

Tourist satisfaction and loyalty are closely linked to overall well-being. Sustaining this level of satisfaction always requires ongoing improvement and innovation in infrastructure, facilities, and the accessibility of the destination's amenities. Strategic investment in improving the area's facilities and amenities builds long-lasting loyalty among tourists seeking a memorable experience.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

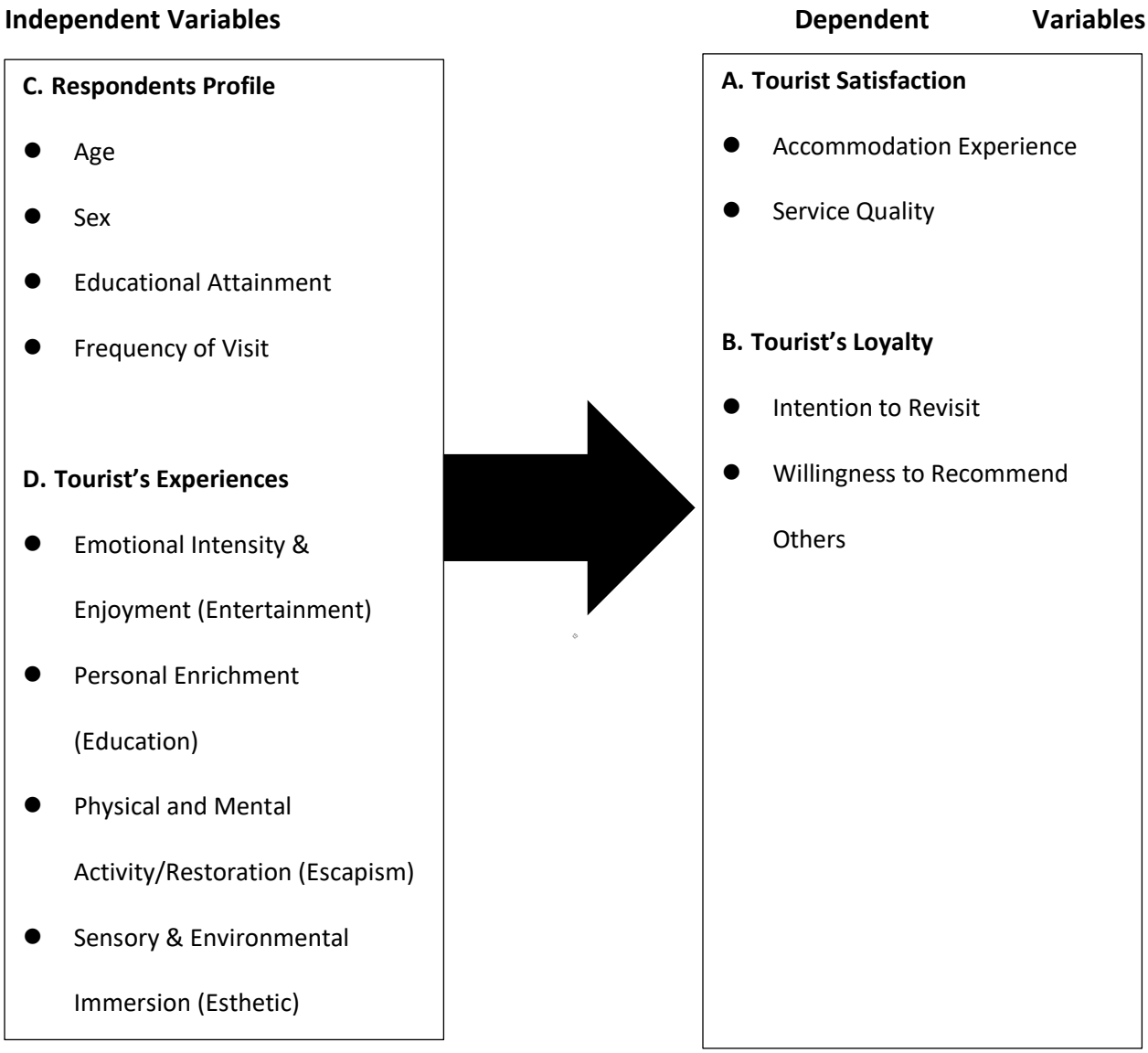


Figure 1. The Schematic Diagram shows the relationship between the dependent and independent variables of the sample.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

The study's primary purpose will determine the tourists' Well-Being and Its Effect on Tourist Satisfaction and Loyalty. It will seek to answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of:

    1.1 Age;

    1.2 Sex;

    1.3 Educational attainment; and

    1.4 Frequency of visit?

2. What is the level of tourist experiences n terms of:

    2.1 Emotional intensity & enjoyment (entertainment);

    2.2 Personal enrichment (education);

    2.3 Physical and mental activity/restoration (escapism); and

    2.4 Sensory & environmental immersion (esthetic)?

3. What is the level of tourist satisfaction in tourist destinations in terms of:

    3.1 Quality of service?

4. What is the level of tourist loyalty in tourist destinations in terms of:

    4.1 Intention to revisit; and

    4.2 Willingness to recommend to others?

5. Is there a significant relationship between the Tourists' Well-Being and Tourist Satisfaction and Loyalty?

1.6. Hypothesis

There is no significant relationship between the Tourists' Well-Being and Tourist Satisfaction and Loyalty.

Scope and Limitations

This study will focus on exploring how the well-being of tourists will affect their satisfaction and loyalty. The respondents of this study will be the tourists in Butuan City who travel and actively engaged in seeking physical, mental, or spiritual rejuvenation through structured activities like retreats or spa services. This limitations of this study will be its results and conclusions will apply exclusively to wellness tourists and will not be used to describe general mass tourists, business travelers, or other traveler types. By limiting the scope, the researchers will aim to provide a detailed and specialized analysis within the wellness niche.

1.7 Definition of Terms

Age. This refers to the number of years the respondent has lived.

Gender. Refers to the femininity and masculinity of the respondents.

Educational attainment. It refers to the highest level of education the tourist has completed.

Emotional Intensity & Enjoyment (Entertainment). This refers to the respondents immediate feeling of pleasure and excitement gets from an experience.

Frequency of visit. It refers to how often a tourist has visited the destination within a specific period.

Intention to Revisit. It refers to respondents' likelihood or desire to return to the same destination in the future, based on their prior experience.

Physical Fitness Opportunities. It refers to the availability of facilities or programs that allow respondents to engage in physical exercises or recreational fitness activities during their stay.

Quality of Service. It refers to the respondents' perception of how efficiently and courteously the staff assist, meet needs, and deliver services.

Spa and Relaxation Services. It refers to the services respondents avail that provide comfort, stress relief, and rejuvenation through treatments such as massages, saunas, and aromatherapy.

Tourist. An individual who travels away from their usual place of residence for leisure, recreation, business, or cultural purposes, usually for less than one year.

Tourist Experience. The collection of activities, interactions, and emotions encountered by tourists during their journey includes cultural exposure, leisure, and service experiences.

Tourist Loyalty. The commitment of tourists to revisit a destination and recommend it to others. Loyalty can be expressed through repeat visits, positive word of mouth, and preference over other destinations.

Tourist Satisfaction: the degree to which a tourist's expectations are met or exceeded by their travel experience. It reflects their overall contentment with the services, activities, and destination.

Tourist Well-Being. Refers to the overall state of a tourist's physical, psychological, and emotional health during their travel experience. It includes how relaxed, safe, and satisfied tourists feel while engaging in leisure or travel activities.

Willingness to Recommend to Others. It refers to respondents' readiness to suggest or endorse the destination to friends, family, or others after a satisfying experience.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1. Research Design

The researchers will use a descriptive research design and a quantitative method. They will survey selected tourists in Butuan City who recently participated in wellness-related travel. The questionnaire will address emotional, psychological, and physical well-being. Researchers will review and summarize responses using basic statistics to examine relationships among tourist experience, satisfaction, and loyalty. This approach studies respondents in their natural state, without manipulating variables (Siedlecki, 2020).

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The researchers will use a modified survey adapted from Bagheri et al. (2023), *"From Tourist Experience to Satisfaction and Loyalty: Exploring the Role of a Sense of Well-Being."* This questionnaire forms the basis for measuring tourist well-being, satisfaction, and loyalty. The team will modify wording for clarity, add location-specific items, and remove irrelevant questions to fit Butuan City. These changes will preserve the core structure and measurement scales of the original to maintain validity.

Before the final survey, researchers will pilot-test the modified instrument to assess clarity, reliability, and suitability. The pilot will use 10–15 respondents, like the real participants, who will not join the main survey. The pilot aims to spot unclear wording, confusing items, or unexpected responses. Researchers will document feedback and use it to further refine the questionnaire.

During modification, the following sections may require revision: (1) Demographic Profile Section, where locally relevant categories may be added; (2) Well-Being Items, which may be

rephrased to fit the local context; (3) Satisfaction and Loyalty Items, which may be contextualized for local destinations and services. If needed, additional statements may be included to measure unique aspects of the city's recreational and wellness offerings.

After the pilot test, the researchers will use reliability measures, like Cronbach's Alpha, to ensure the questionnaire demonstrates internal consistency. Items with an acceptable reliability below will be revised or removed. The revised instrument will then be submitted to the school's Research Office for formal validation. The office will review the questionnaire's accuracy, appropriateness, and alignment with research standards.

Once validated, the final questionnaire will be given to target respondents. Respondents will select from set response options to provide numerical data for the study's objectives. We will statistically analyze the responses to assess how tourists' experiences relate to their satisfaction and loyalty.

Research Locale

This study will be conducted in Butuan City, a highly urbanised city located in the province of Agusan del Norte, Caraga Region, Philippines. Known as the "Home of the Balangays," Butuan City is rich in history, culture, and natural attractions, making it one of Mindanao's emerging tourist destinations. The city offers a wide range of tourism experiences, including cultural and historical tours, eco-tourism activities, and modern leisure facilities, attracting both local and foreign visitors. The research environment provides an ideal setting to assess tourist satisfaction, experience, and loyalty, as it is a growing hub of tourism development in the region.

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The study will be conducted in Butuan City, a developing urban destination known for cultural heritage sites and wellness businesses. The research covers selected accommodations and wellness centers. These locations were chosen for high visitor volume, accessibility, and relevance to tourist experience, satisfaction, and loyalty. The establishment list was compiled through the Butuan City Tourism Office directory, online tourism platforms, and site visits. Establishments were then categorized into (1) Spa and (2) Fitness gym**.**

The study population includes all tourists who have visited or are currently visiting Butuan City during the data collection period. This population comprises local travelers in the city for relaxation, cultural exploration, or business. From this population, the researchers will select respondents who meet the defined inclusion criteria: (1) must be at least 18 years old, (2) must have visited a Spa and Fitness Gym establishment in Butuan City, and (3) must be willing to participate voluntarily. The exclusion criteria include: (1) residents of Butuan City (to avoid bias from locals who are not tourists), (2) tourists below 18 years old, and (3) individuals who have not engaged in any tourism activity during their stay.

The researchers will employ convenience sampling, selecting participants based on their availability and willingness to complete the survey during their visit. This technique is appropriate given the natural flow of tourists across various establishments, making it practical and efficient for data collection. To ensure fair representation, the researchers will distribute the target number of respondents across establishment categories. The distribution will be based on estimated tourist volume and accessibility, ensuring that each type of establishment's wellness facilities contribute proportionately to the total sample.

The sample size of ___ tourists (number to be filled in by your group based on your required sample size computation) is considered sufficient to collect meaningful and reliable data. The distribution of respondents across establishment categories will reflect the estimated percentage of tourist visits: the higher the visitor flow, the larger the proportion assigned to that category. This method ensures that the gathered responses accurately reflect the experiences of tourists across different sectors of Butuan City's tourism environment.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

This research will be analyzed using quantitative statistical methods to measure and evaluate tourists' well-being and its impact on tourist satisfaction and loyalty. The collected survey data will be organized and analyzed by the researchers using statistical tools. Descriptive statistics, such as frequencies, percentages, means, and standard deviations, will be used to summarize participants' responses. The results will be presented in tables, graphs, and descriptive summaries based on the collected data. This systematic approach will enable the researchers to draw objective conclusions from numerical data, providing an evidence-based understanding of tourists' experience and its effects to tourist satisfaction and loyalty.

2.5. Research Ethical Standards

The researcher caters to the ethical concern to maintain the respondent's privacy in the review process:

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The researchers will ensure that all resources used are correctly credited to their original authors and used with permission. The findings of this study will be based on the data gathered by the

researchers. The researchers maintain the confidentiality of the data collected. The researchers will ensure they avoid plagiarism, unauthorised reproduction, or misrepresentation of information from other authors or studies. The researchers will ensure transparency and integrity in the analysis of the results. Any intellectual property, including confidential reports or investigative techniques, must be handled responsibly to prevent misuse or unauthorised disclosure. The researchers will respect IPR by ensuring that any work they produce, such as publications or inventions, acknowledges the contributions of others and does not infringe on existing patents or copyrights.

B. Informed Consent

An informed consent form will be provided to the respondents to confirm that their participation is entirely voluntary. It will also let them know that they have the right to withdraw from the study at any time without negative consequences. The respondents will be thoroughly informed about the study's purpose, procedures, potential risks, and benefits through a detailed orientation conducted by the researchers.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

All personal information from participants will be kept anonymous by removing names and other identifying details, unless the participant agrees to be identified in the study. Before data collection, the researchers will also seek permission from the following spa and gym establishments to administer the survey on their premises. The data will be safely stored in a password-protected file on a secure device. Only the researchers will have access to the data, and it will be used solely for the study, in accordance with data privacy rules.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

The respondents can choose to join the study on their own, without being forced. The researchers will avoid causing any physical, emotional, or mental harm to the respondents during this study. Participants will also be informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any time.

E. Minimisation of Harm and Risk Management

Maximising benefits and minimising risks for respondents, ensuring that all questions are respectful and do not cause discomfort or harm. Participation will be voluntary, and respondents can skip any question they are not comfortable answering. In case a participant feels any distress during the process, they will be given the option to stop immediately. If needed, the researchers will refer them to any available support service. If required, the researchers will refer them to available support services. The researchers will also refer respondents to the school guidance counsellor, mental health professionals, or local support organisations that provide emotional or psychological support.

F. Beneficence and Contribution to Knowledge

This study aims to provide insights that can guide future research and practice within the academic community. The data collected is truthful, accurate, and free from errors. The study's findings will be made available to participants upon request, ensuring transparency and respect for their contributions. Additionally, the results will be presented to the public through appropriate platforms, such as academic presentations, community events, school bulletins, or journal publications, ensuring that both the respondents and society at large can benefit from the research outcomes.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

The respondents in this study will be selected based on relevant expertise and experience.

The selection process will uphold ethical principles by providing equal opportunities for qualified individuals while ensuring their rights and experiences. The researchers will ensure justice and fairness in participant selection by applying unbiased, equitable criteria. The inclusion criteria for selecting the participating spas and gyms are based on establishments that (1) have a consistent flow of tourists, (2) offer wellness-related services such as spa treatments, fitness activities, or relaxation amenities, and (3) are officially registered and recognized by local tourism or business authorities in Butuan City. These establishments are chosen because they align directly with the study's focus on the tourist experience, satisfaction, and loyalty.

Meanwhile, establishments were excluded if they (1) do not cater to tourists, (2) do not offer wellness or fitness services, (3) have very limited visitor interaction, or (4) declined participation. By applying these criteria, only the most relevant spas and gyms were selected to ensure that the data accurately represent wellness-related tourist experiences in Butuan City.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The research team will use established procedures to accurately record and interpret feedback and performance data. AI was used early in the analysis to organise ideas and summarise initial insights. The final report will be checked for good grammar and clarity. The team will carefully review all AI results to avoid mistakes or misinterpretations. Researchers will also ensure that all copyrighted materials are used with permission and in accordance with intellectual property laws.

I. Transparency and Honesty in Reporting

The researchers will disclose their findings clearly and honestly, without omitting any vital i

nformation, even if it conflicts with their expectations. All results will be reported truthfully and transparently. Additionally, all copyrighted and patented materials used in the study will be appropriately cited and acknowledged to credit the sources and avoid plagiarism.

J. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

Researchers will refrain from unauthorised reproduction, distribution, or modification of copyrighted documents, reports, or patented methodologies. Ethical responsibility requires that all materials used in the study are legally obtained and properly credited to respect the rights of original creators. If any copyrighted materials, such as software or literature, are needed, the researchers will seek and obtain the appropriate permissions before use.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

Confidentiality, consent, and voluntary participation are top ethical priorities for people in this study. Researchers will fully inform participants about the study's purpose and risks. They will know they can quit at any time with no penalty. All private information and notes will be kept secret to protect their privacy and safety. We promise to treat all participants with respect and care.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Other Related Technologies

The researchers will ensure that AI tools are used to enhance data analysis and information processing without bias, manipulation, or misrepresentation. AI-generated content will be carefully reviewed and verified for credibility to maintain the accuracy and integrity of the study. Tools such as ChatGPT, QuillBot, Grammarly, and Mendeley will be used to assist with grammar checking, summarising literature, organising ideas, and managing references. QuillBot will be

used for paraphrasing and rewording sentences; Grammarly will help improve grammar, punctuation, and overall writing clarity; and Mendeley will be used for managing citations and references, ensuring proper citation formatting and organisation throughout the study.

M. Ethical Clearance and Institutional Approval

Researchers must get ethical clearance and institutional approval from the Institutional Research Committee of Saint Michael College of Caraga (SMCC) before collecting any data. The study plan will be sent to the proper ethics review board. This ensures we follow all ethical guidelines, especially when handling sensitive information. Approval from the IRB and related institutions is required. This is necessary to maintain research integrity, protect participants' rights, and ensure compliance with all legal and ethical standards.

NOTE: We don’t have the data yet.

REFERENCES

Albasrie, A. D. A., Himawan, I. S., & Sharipudin, M. N. S. (2024). A study of the effect of tourist experience quality on loyalty and revisit intention in tourist destinations. Asia Marketing Journal, 26.https://doi.org/10.2478/amns-2024-3103

1. Almeida-Santana, A., & Moreno-Gil, S. (2018). Understanding tourism loyalty: Horizontal vs. destination loyalty. Tourism Management, 65, 245–255. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2017.10.011
2. Al-okaily, N. S., Alzboun, N., Alrawadieh, Z., & Slehat, M. (2023). The impact of eudaimonic well-being on experience and loyalty: a tourism context. Journal of Services Marketing, 37(2), 216–231. https://doi.org/10.1108/JSM-08-2021-0282
3. Anglim, J., Horwood, S., Smillie, L. D., Marrero, R. J., & Wood, J. K. (2020). Predicting psychological and subjective well-being from personality: A meta-analysis. Psychological Bulletin, 146(4), 279–323. https://doi.org/10.1037/bul0000226
4. Bagheri, F., Guerreiro, M., Pinto, P., & Ghaderi, Z. (2024). From Tourist Experience to Satisfaction and Loyalty: Exploring the Role of a Sense of Well-Being. Journal of Travel Research, 63(8), 1989–2004. https://doi.org/10.1177/00472875231201509
5. Balderas-Cejudo, A., & Patterson, I. (2023). Tourism as a Means of Happiness and Subjective Well-Being for Senior Travelers. Anduli, 23, 19–33. https://doi.org/10.12795/anduli.2023.i23.02
6. Breiby, M. A., & Slåtten, T. (2018). The role of aesthetic experiential qualities for tourist satisfaction and loyalty. International Journal of Culture, Tourism and Hospitality Research, 12(1), 1–14. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJCTHR-07-2017-0082
7. Biswas C, Deb SK, Hasan AA, Khandakar MSA (2021), "Mediating effect of tourists' emotional involvement on the relationship between destination attributes and tourist satisfaction". Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Insights, Vol. 4 No. 4 pp. 490–510, doi: https://doi.org/10.1108/JHTI-05-2020-0075
8. Cheng, X., Fu, S., Sun, J., Bilgihan, A., & Okumus, F. (2019). An investigation on online reviews in sharing economy driven hospitality platforms: A viewpoint of trust. Tourism Management, 71, 366–377. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2018.10.020
9. Chua, B.-L., Kim, S. (Sam), Ling, E. S. W., Xu, Y., Ryu, H. B., & Han, H. (2025a). Wellness tourism destination loyalty formation: the role of mental health and eudaimonic well-being. Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Insights, 8(3), 1049–1072. https://doi.org/10.1108/JHTI-06-2024-0551
10. Coles, R. M. (2022). A Time Series Analysis of Siargao Tourist Arrivals. International Journal of Science and Management Studies (IJSMS), 193–199. https://doi.org/10.51386/25815946/ijsms-v5i2p119
11. Chaoyi, C., Huijuan, L., & Zhenbin, W. (2025). Influencing factors of tourist loyalty in China camping destinations based on Expectation Confirmation Theory: the mediating role of satisfaction and well-being.

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, 12(1), 1418.https://www.nature.com/articles/s41599-025-05803-x

12. Câmara, E., Pocinho, M., Neves de Jesus, S., & Agapito, D. (2024). Senior Tourists' Well-being, Happiness, and Satisfaction with Life: A Systematic Literature Review. Journal of Tourism, Sustainability and Well-Being, 12(2), 87–110. https://doi.org/10.34623/jc4r-9a80
13. Dimitrovski D, Marinković V, Djordjevic A, Sthapit E (2025), "Wellness spa hotel experience: evidence from spa hotel guests in Serbia". Tourism Review, Vol. 80 No. 6 pp. 1300–1319, doi: https://doi.org/10.1108/TR-11-2023-0770
14. Dutt, B., & Selstad, L. (2022). The wellness modification of yoga in Norway. International Journal of Spa and Wellness, 5(1),33–49.https://doi.org/10.1080/24721735.2021.1948274
15. Guerreiro, M., Pinto, P., deMatos, N., Bagheri, F., Sequeira, B. D., & Parra, A. (2025). Unveiling the impacts of tourist experiences on experiential image, satisfaction, and loyalty: A study in Algarve, a European premier beach destination. Journal of Vacation Marketing, 0(0). https://doi.org/10.1177/13567667251335045.
16. Gao, J., Meng, F., Guo, W., & Lin, B. (2024). Achieving destination sustainability: How tourist-to-tourist interaction quality affects tourist loyalty? PLOS ONE, 19(8), e0296944. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0296944
17. Gupta, S., Nath Mishra, O., & Kumar, S. (2023). Tourist participation, well-being and satisfaction: the mediating roles of service experience and tourist empowerment. Current Issues in Tourism, 26(16), 2613–2628. https://doi.org/10.1080/13683500.2022.2091429
18. Han, H., Kiatkawsin, K., Jung, H., & Kim, W. (2018). The role of wellness spa tourism performance in building destination loyalty: the case of Thailand. Journal of Travel & Tourism Marketing, 35(5), 595–610. https://doi.org/10.1080/10548408.2017.1376031
19. Hartwell, H., Fyall, A., Willis, C., Page, S., Ladkin, A., & Hemingway, A. (2018). Progress in tourism and destination wellbeing research. Current Issues in Tourism, 21(16), 1830– 1892. https://doi.org/10.1080/13683500.2016.1223609
20. Hung, V. V., Dey, S. K., Vaculčikova, Z., & Anh, L. T. H. (2021). The Influence of Tourists' Experience on Destination Loyalty: A Case Study of Hue City, Vietnam. Sustainability, 13(16), 8889. https://www.mdpi.com/2071-1050/13/16/8889
21. He, M., Liu, B., & Li, Y. (2021). Tourist Inspiration: How the Wellness Tourism Experience Inspires Tourist Engagement. Journal of Hospitality & Tourism Research, 47(7), 1115-1135.https://doi.org/10.1177/10963480211026376
22. Ismadi, I., & Suwitho, S. (2024). THE EFFECT OF TOURISM ATTRACTION AND TOURIST EXPERIENCE ON REVISIT INTENTION MEDIATED BY TOURIST SATISFACTION (A STUDY AT MOUNT BROMO TOURIST

DESTINATION, EAST JAVA). International Conference of Business and Social Sciences, 3(1), 474–486. https://doi.org/10.24034/icobuss.v3i1.401

23. Javdan, Mojtaba., Jafarpour Ghalehteimouri, K., Soleimani, M., & Pavee, S. (2024). Community attitudes toward tourism and quality of life: a case study of Palangan village, Iran. Discover Environment, 2(1), 117. https://doi.org/10.1007/s44274-024-00154-x
24. Kan, T., Ku, E. C. S., Sun, W. C. W., Lai, T.-C., Hsu, P.-Y., & Hsu, S. (2023). Wellness Tourism Enhances Elderly Life Satisfaction. Journal of Quality Assurance in Hospitality & Tourism, 24(4), 402–428. https://doi.org/10.1080/1528008X.2022.2052394
25. Kesuma, T. M., Priantana, R. D., Siregar, M. R., Humaira, R., & Muzammil, A. (2025). Residents' Well-Being and Sustainable Governance in Island Tourism: The Evidence from Aceh, Indonesia. Tourism and Hospitality, 6(3), 131. https://doi.org/10.3390/tourhosp6030131
26. Koh, E., Fakfare, P., & Pongwat, A. (2022). The limits of Thai hospitality – perceived impact of tourism development on residents' well-being in Chiang Mai. International Journal of Tourism Cities, 8(1), 187–209. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJTC-03-2020-0055
27. Kwon, J., & Lee, H. (2020). Why travel prolongs happiness: Longitudinal analysis using a latent growth model. Tourism Management, 76, 103944. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2019.06.019
28. Liao, C.-S., & Chuang, H.-K. (2020). Tourist preferences for package tour attributes in tourism destination design and development. Journal of Vacation Marketing, 26(2), 230–246. https://doi.org/10.1177/1356766719880250
29. Libre, A., Manalo, A., & Laksito, G. S. (2022). Factors Influencing Philippines Tourist' Revisit Intention: The Role and Effect of Destination Image, Tourist Experience, Perceived Value, and Tourist Satisfaction. International Journal of Quantitative Research and Modeling, 3(1), 1–12. https://doi.org/10.46336/ijqrm.v3i1.260
30. Liu, L., Zhou, Y., & Sun, X. (2023). The Impact of the Wellness Tourism Experience on Tourist Well-Being: The Mediating Role of Tourist Satisfaction. Sustainability, 15(3), 1872. https://doi.org/10.3390/su15031872
31. Liberato, D., Brandão, F., Teixeira, A. S., & Liberato, P. (2021). Satisfaction and loyalty evaluation towards health and wellness destination. Journal of Tourism & Development, 36(2), 9-24. https://doi.org/10.34624/rtd.v2i36.24679
32. Mercado, A. P., & Apritado, J. M. M. (2021). Tourism risk impact on the destination image of Batangas province. International Journal of Research Studies in Management, 9(3). https://doi.org/10.5861/ijrsm.2021.m7732
33. Milojica, V., & Alkier Tomić, R. (2025). Satisfaction of Visitors with the Wellness Tourist Services of Republic of Croatia. UTMS Journal of Economics, 16(1), 62–73. https://ideas.repec.org/a/ris/utmsje/021621.html

34. Nyame, J., & Anderson, A. N. (2025). Examining the Impact of Cultural Diversity on Tourist Satisfaction: An Empirical Study in Ghana's Western Region Hospitality and Tourism Industry. American Journal of Tourism and Hospitality, 3(1), 152–162. https://doi.org/10.54536/ajth.v3i1.4756
35. Parilla, E. S. (2023). Tourist Engagement and Destination Loyalty Among Local Visitors in the Philippines. International Journal of Entrepreneurship, Business and Creative Economy, 3(2), 46–59. https://doi.org/10.31098/ijebce.v3i2.1272
36. Park, S., & Ahn, D. (2022). Seeking Pleasure or Meaning? The Different Impacts of Hedonic and Eudaimonic Tourism Happiness on Tourists' Life Satisfaction. International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, 19(3), 1162. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph19031162
37. Qiu, H., Li, M., & Zhang, J. (2024). Perceived value, tourist satisfaction, and loyalty: Evidence from destination tourism. Frontiers in Psychology, 15, 1290021. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1290021
38. Rahman, A., Farooq, N., Haleem, M., Shah, S. M. A., & El-Gohary, H. (2023). Exploring the Pathways to Tourist Loyalty in Pakistani Tourism Industry: The Role of Destination Image, Service Quality, E-WOM, and Social Media. Sustainability, 15(24), 16601. https://doi.org/10.3390/su152416601
39. Rahmawati, L., & Hadi, S. (2024). The impact of destination quality and image on tourists' loyalty. Tourism Research Journal, 8(2), 101–113. https://trj.iptrisakti.ac.id/index.php/trj/article/view/262
40. Sulkaisi, S., Irwan, N., & Neffi, I. (2021). Influence of destination attributes on tourists' satisfaction and their impact on tourists' loyalty. Journal of Tourism Research, 5(2), 45–58.https://www.researchgate.net/publication/366639864
41. Saragih, H. S., & Amelia, N. (2020). Segmentation of music festival visitors by values of hedonia, life satisfaction and eudaimonia. International Journal of Event and Festival Management, 11(4), 453–472. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJEFM-03-2020-0016
42. Sarial-Abi, G., Merdin-Uygur, E., & Gürhan-Canli, Z. (2020). Responses to replica (vs. genuine) touristic experiences. Annals of Tourism Research, 83, 102927. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2020.102927
43. Serrona, K., Yu, J., & Camarin, M. (2022). Addressing Marine Litter Through Sustainable Tourism: The Case of the Siargao Islands in the Southern Philippines. SSRN Electronic Journal. https://doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4204147
44. Singh, R., Manhas, P. S., Mir, M. A., & Quintela, J. A. (2022). Investigating the Relationship between Experience, Well-Being, and Loyalty: A Study of Wellness Tourists. Administrative Sciences, 12(3), 98. https://doi.org/10.3390/admsci12030098
45. Su, L., Tang, B., & Nawijn, J. (2021). How tourism activity shapes travel experience sharing: Tourist well-being and social context. Annals of Tourism Research, 91, 103316. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.annals.2021.103316

46. Suban SA (2025), "Visitor's emotional experience in predicting destination image, satisfaction and intention to revisit: a spa tourism perspective". International Hospitality Review, Vol. 39 No. 2 pp. 355–376, doi: https://doi.org/10.1108/IHR-05-2023-0032
47. Suhartanto, D., Dean, D., Wibisono, N., Astor, Y., Muflih, M., Kartikasari, A., Sutrisno, R., & Hardiyanto, N. (2020). Tourist experience in Halal tourism: What leads to loyalty? Current Issues in Tourism. https://doi.org/10.1080/13683500.2020.1813092
48. Sulkaisi, N., Idris, I., Siska, F., & Irwan, I. (2021). The effect of service quality on tourist satisfaction and tourist loyalty. Proceedings of the 5th Asia-Pacific Conference on Economic Research and Management Innovation (ERMI 2021), 167. Atlantis Press. https://doi.org/10.2991/aebmr.k.211128.001
49. Surya, E. D. S., & Suwarno, B. (2023). Memorable Tourism Experience: Building Satisfaction and Loyalty of Tourists (Case Study of Medan City, Indonesia). International Journal of Economics Development Research (IJEDR), 4(2), 507–522. https://doi.org/10.37385/ijedr.v4i2.3055
50. Sthapit, E., Björk, P., & Coudounaris, D. N. (2023). Towards a better understanding of memorable wellness tourism experience. International Journal of Spa and Wellness, 6(1), 1–27. https://doi.org/10.1080/24721735.2022.2136120
51. Sthapit, E., Ji, C., Li, M., Garrod, B., Ibrahim, B., & Björk, P. (2025). Memorable wellness tourism experiences: antecedents that lead to enjoyable outcomes. International Journal of Spa and Wellness, 8(2), 155–181. https://doi.org/10.1080/24721735.2025.2473124
52. Smith, M. K., Jancsik, A., & Puczkó, L. (2020). Customer satisfaction in post-socialist Spas: a case study of Budapest, City of Spas. International Journal of Spa and Wellness, 3(2–3), 165–186. https://doi.org/10.1080/24721735.2020.1866330
53. Seow, A. N., Foroughi, B., & Choong, Y. O. (2024). Tourists' Satisfaction, Experience, and Revisit Intention for Wellness Tourism: E Word-of-Mouth as the Mediator. Sage Open, 14(3).https://doi.org/10.1177/21582440241274049
54. Saayman, M., Li, G., Uysal, M., & Song, H. (2018). Tourist satisfaction and subjective well-being: An index approach. International Journal of Tourism Research, 20(3), 388–399. https://doi.org/10.1002/jtr.2190
55. Vada, S., Filep, S., Moyle, B., Gardiner, S., & Tuguinay, J. (2023). Welcome back: Repeat visitation and tourist wellbeing. Tourism Management, 98, 104747. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2023.104747
56. Xu, W., & Zhang, X. (2021). Online expression as Well-be(com)ing: A study of travel blogs on Nepal by Chinese female tourists. Tourism Management, 83, 104224. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tourman.2020.104224
57. Yudhistira, P. G. A., Kurniasari, N. M. D. R., Putri, J. M. K., & Octaviani, N. (2025). Radiant living: embarking on a journey to well-being through wellness tourism experience, divided by tourist satisfaction and fear of

missing out. International Journal of Spa and Wellness, 8(1), 106–124. https://doi.org/10.1080/24721735.2025.2450155

58. Zhang, H., Xu, F., & Li, Y. (2023). The impact of tourism satisfaction and service quality on destination loyalty. Sustainability, 15(9), 7713.https://doi.org/10.3390/su15097713
59. Zhou, M.; Yu, H. (2022). Exploring How Tourist Engagement Affectstion loyaltyDestination Loyalty: The Intermediary Role of Value and Satisfaction. Sustainability, 14,1621. https://doi.org/10.3390/1

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

RESEARCH QUESTIONNAIRE

Part 1: Respondent's Profile

Instructions:

Please answer this questionnaire properly and sincerely by putting a check mark (/) in the space that best corresponds to your observation on the following items using the following criteria;

1. **Age**-

☐ 18-23 years old

☐ 24-31 years old

☐ 32 years old and above

2. Gender

☐ Male

☐ Female

3. **Educational Attainment**

☐ Elementary Level

☐ High School Graduate

☐ College Graduate

Part II: Exploring the Tourists Experience and Its Effect to Tourist Satisfaction and Loyalty

Instructions:

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

Please check the statement using the scale provided which you think is much applicable to you.

We want you to be as accurate as possible since the successful result of this survey will depend on you.

Rating Scale	Verbal Description	Verbal Interpretation
4	Strongly Agree	The statement discuss always true to the respondents
3	Agree	The statement discuss always to the respondents
2	Disagree	The statement discuss sometimes true to the respondents
1	Strongly Disagree	The statement discuss never true to the respondents

A. The Tourists Experiences as to: Emotional Intensity & Enjoyment (Entertainment), Personal Enrichment (Education), Physical and Mental Activity/Restoration (Escapism), and Sensory & Environmental Immersion (Esthetic)

Emotional Intensity & Enjoyment (Entertainment)	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. The Gym experience made me feel very energized and alive.				
2. The service created a strong emotional reaction (like deep relaxation or great excitement).				
3. The environment made me feel mentally stimulated.				
4. . I felt a powerful rush of good feeling from the experience.				
5. The experience was very memorable because of how it made me feel.				

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

6. The Spa/Gym experience was fun and delightful.				
7. II felt a great sense of pleasure during the session/workout.				
8. I found the activities to be very entertaining.				
9. The experience helped me relax and simply enjoy myself.				
10. I laughed or smiled a lot while using the facilities/service.				

Personal Enrichment (Education)	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. I felt a strong sense of personal growth (body and mind) from the trip.				
2. The trip helped me feel physically healthier and mentally clearer.				
3. I gained skills and knowledge that improved my competence (ability to do things).				
4. The experience added meaning and purpose to my life.				
5. I returned from the trip feeling truly refreshed and recharged in every way.				
6. The trip allowed me to discover new things about myself.				
7. . I feel more confident in myself because of the learning and wellness gained.				

8. The trip reduced my stress and made me feel calmer overall.				
9. I developed new interests or hobbies during this trip.				
10. This experience motivated me to maintain a healthier lifestyle.				

Physical and Mental Activity/Restoration (Escapism)	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Disagree (2)**	**Strongly Disagree (1)**
1. The spa service helped me completely forget about my daily worries.				
2. The spa environment allowed me to feel totally separated from my normal life.				
3. The treatment felt like a deep mental escape and relief.				
4. I felt fully restored and peaceful after the spa experience.				
5. I was able to recharge my body and mind during the spa visit.				
6. The gym facilities were conveniently located within the tourist area.				
7. It was easy and fast to access the gym whenever I wanted during the trip.				
8. The gym equipment available met all my needs for a vacation workout.				

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

9. The operating hours of the gym allowed me to easily fit workouts into my schedule.				
10. The cost of using the gym was reasonable and did not discourage me from going.				

Sensory & Environmental Immersion (Esthetic)	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Disagree (2)**	**Agree (1)**
1. The visual design and decor of the spa were beautiful and calming.				
2.The aromas (smells) and music (sounds) created a highly immersive atmosphere.				
3.The overall spa environment made me feel fully transported to a different, peaceful place.				
4.The texture and feeling of the materials (e.g., towels, oils) enhanced the luxury experience.				
5.The aesthetic quality of the spa strongly contributed to my feeling of relaxation.				
6The design and cleanliness of the gym space were motivating and pleasant.				
7.The gym offered a view or environment (e.g., lighting, windows) that enhanced my workout.				
8.The gym's acoustics and background sounds (e.g., music, lack of noise) were appropriate.				
9.The overall atmosphere of the gym made me feel deeply engaged in my fitness activity.				
10.The modern and high-quality appearance of the facilities made the experience special.				

B. What is the level of Tourist Satisfaction as to: Service Quality

Service Quality	Strongly Agree (4)	Agree (3)	Strongly Disagree (2)	Agree (1)
1. The staff (e.g., therapists, trainers, reception) were polite, friendly, and welcoming.				
2. Staff demonstrated professional knowledge and competence during the service/session.				
3. . Staff provided personalized attention and focused on my specific needs.				
4. Staff were dependable (e.g., started appointments on time, provided clear instructions).				
5. Staff handled the booking process or any issues quickly and efficiently.				
6. The consistency of service among all SPA/Gym employees makes me confident in the brand's quality.				
7. The staff at the SPA desk displayed the knowledge and courtesy (Assurance) that instilled my trust in their services.				

8. The tangible quality (cleanliness, ambiance, equipment state) of the SPA and Fitness Gym facilities was excellent.				
9. When I had a problem or request, the staff's responsiveness helped resolve the issue to my satisfaction.				
10. My high satisfaction with the quality of the services I received will lead me to be a loyal, repeat guest.				

C. What is the level of Tourist Loyalty as to

Intention to Revisit	**Strongly Agree (4)**	**Agree (3)**	**Strongly Disagree (2)**	**Agree (1)**
1. I would revisit this resort for a future wellness-focused trip (including the SPA/Gym).				
2. Given my positive experience, this resort will be my first choice for a similar vacation in the future.				
3. I would be willing to pay a premium to stay at this specific resort again.				
4. I plan to increase the frequency of my visits to this specific brand/chain of resorts.				
5. I consider myself a loyal customer of this resort due to the overall quality of its services and amenities.				
6. I would still choose to revisit this resort.				

7. I intend to visit this resort again within the next two years.				
8. This resort has become my preferred destination for wellness-related travel..				
9. I feel a sense of attachment to this resort, encouraging me to return.				
10. I would be willing to overlook minor issues in the future because of the quality of this past experience.				

SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

Willingness to Recommend Others	Strongly Agree (4)	Agree (3)	Strongly Disagree (2)	Agree (1)
1. I will recommend this resort to my family and friends seeking a relaxing and wellness-focused vacation.				
2. I would encourage others to specifically use the SPA and Fitness Gym facilities at this resort.				
3. I intend to post positive comments or reviews about this resort online (e.g., social media, travel sites).				
4. I will speak highly of the staff and services provided at this resort.				
5. The experience I had at this resort is one I am enthusiastic about sharing with others.				
6. I am confident that my friends/family would have a similar positive experience here.				
7. I will actively share photos and positive details of my experience on social media platforms.				
8. I would recommend this resort over competitors based on the quality of the SPA and Fitness Gym.				

9. I will actively defend this resort if I hear someone speaking negatively about it.				
10. My experience here was so good that I would encourage others to book immediately.				